



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate

NOV 2020

Time Change

It will soon be time to fall back and gain that hour we lost in the spring. Set your clocks back one hour before tuning in to worship on Sunday, Nov. 1.

Are you on Facebook?
Join our private Minnehaha Community Page!

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Annual Holiday Bazaar

First Annual COVID-Safe Christmas Bazaar Presented by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

Saturday, November 14

10:00 a.m. — 2:00 p.m.

We're cooking our delicious lunches.

Place your order at home for
pick-up or drive-up

(see back of this sheet):

*Chicken Noodle Hot Dish
with cole slaw and
cranberry sauce.*

Or...

Sloppy Joe, chips and pickle.

And don't forget dessert!

*Pumpkin or apple pie,
or chocolate cake.*

When you come to pick up lunch, stop at our socially
distanced mini-bazaar to buy your favorite items.

Please wear a mask.



Use the Order Form On the Back of This Sheet. It's Easy!



Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street • Minneapolis, MN 55417

(612) 721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org



Charge Conference

Charge Conference is the official word we use for an all-church meeting that takes place during Church Council. The reason for our charge conference on Nov. 10 will be the setting of salary for Becky Sechrist. We do this before the formal budget is adopted because the denomination requires that all salaries be set by December 1 so that the numbers can be processed by the pensions people. If our budgeting process prompts a change in salary, then we can make a correction and vote on it the same time we vote on the budget, sending in amended paperwork at that time. Everyone is always welcome to attend a Church Council meeting, and anyone who is a member can vote at the charge conference.

Taizé

Our Taizé service for October has been posted! If you have always wondered about this quieter, more meditative worship service, this is a great opportunity to check it out. On our website, find the Taizé button, and you can get links to the livestreamed Taizé service from October, as well as access our distantly-recorded services from earlier in the year.

We will also have a new Taizé service for you on Election Day eve as well, so that you have a quiet, restorative, soul-filling break from the news that day.



Worship in November

Online only worship continues in November. We'll acknowledge the lives of all those we have lost in the last year on November 1, and we'll end the month with the beginning of Advent in November 29. In between, be sure to tune in to our livestreamed (vs. pre-recorded) worship in Nov. 8, and then hear some more stories from the lives of members of our congregation on Nov. 15 and Nov. 22.

November 1	"Saying and Doing" - All Saints Sunday <i>Matthew 21:1-12</i>
November 8	"We Serve God" - Livestreamed! <i>Joshua 24:1-3a, 14-25</i>
November 15	Faith In Action: Interview with Kim Kanuit and Scott Gruenhagen <i>Matthew 25:14-29</i>
November 22	Faith in Action: Interview with Joan Ellison, Chris Kramer, and Eric Strom <i>Psalms 24:1-2</i>
November 25	Thanksgiving Eve Ecumenical pre-recorded service.
November 29	"Keep Awake" Advent Begins <i>Isaiah 64:1-9</i>

Recordings of Scripture Readers and Acolytes Needed

We will probably be doing exclusively online worship for a number of months, so we are looking for a variety of faces and voices in our worship service. If you are willing to video record yourself reading the scripture lesson or lighting our candle, please contact either Jenia Strom or Becky Sechrist. We can give you the parameters for your recording (hold your phone sideways, how long the recording should be, etc.), and give you the link for uploading your video. All recordings need to be done at least by Thursday for the coming Sunday, but can be recorded much further in advance of that if you want!

Do Not Be Afraid. Advent 2020 with Minnehaha UMC

Advent begins November 29th, and while we can't be together to observe this season, we together will find our way towards Christmas - we will find ways to bring light into the darkness - we will find ways to *not be afraid* in a world that can feel terrifying.

For each Minnehaha household, we have an Advent Bag with supplies to help you join in and observe the season. As you are able to, we invite you to pick up the bag at Minnehaha sometime during the following window.

MINNEHAHA ADVENT KIT PICK-UP

Sunday, November 22nd: 11am to 1pm

Tuesday, November 24th: 3-8pm

Wednesday, November 25th: From 10am-noon & 3-7pm

We will deliver all bags that are not picked up on Friday, Nov. 27th & Saturday, Nov. 29th.

Looking back at October with Minnehaha Children, Youth, & Families



KEEP THE CAMPFIRE GLOWING

On October 10th, we hosted a Family Fun Day and Campout to raise money for the Minnesota Conference Camps. It was a beautiful day & night, and we had a wonderful time together. And, we raised \$1200 for the camps. Thank you for your generosity!

CHILDREN

Preschoolers through fifth graders have been gathering once a week via zoom and visiting the Google Classroom as we make our way through the Beatitudes together.

Members of Minnehaha Children's Choir gathered to make and learn how to plan Taiko (Japanese drums), culminating in a recorded performance for worship on Oct. 18th.

YOUTH

Youth have continued to bike, craft, cook, and film together weekly. We've been grateful for technology and good weather to allow these to continue.

In his past month we explored the Minnesota River Valley, Ft. Snelling Trails and more. We've felted pumpkins and whittled, made cookies and energy bars and have about wrapped up our own version of Star Wars: A New Hope. We also resumed our Sunday morning check-ins at the end of September, ninth graders are meeting weekly for Confirmation, and Middle Schoolers are gathering for grade level gatherings outside at various locations.

We are so very to all the volunteers & participants who make these possible!

To be added to our email list/get links for online gatherings, contact
Jenia Stomat education@minnehaha.org



Thanksgiving Eve Worship -- Online

This year's ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve service will be available online the day before Thanksgiving. The various congregations (Lake Nokomis Lutheran, Hope Lutheran, Living Table, Bethel Lutheran, Richfield Lutheran) will

each contribute a portion of the service, and we'll stitch it all together for all of us. Look for an email on that Wednesday which will give you the direct link. You can also access it through our website, at the "click here to worship

with us" icon. See elsewhere in the newsletter for details of an outdoor, in-person opportunity that evening as well where you can listen to Anders play the organ and pick up your bag of Advent supplies.



Calling For Your Candle-Lighting Video

We probably can't pass the candle light on Christmas Eve this year, but that doesn't mean we can't do it digitally! We are looking for your videos – pick up a candle from the church (they are outside the front doors in a labeled container). Set your camera on landscape mode (sideways), and start with yourself holding the candle, unlit, in front of you. Take the unlit candle in your left hand and move it to the left, out of sight of the camera. Have someone light it, then move the candle back into the screen and pass it to your right, off screen again. We'll collect these videos and stitch them together so that we are able to pass the candlelight to one another on Christmas Eve. You can upload to the link in the weekly emails, or, if you have any trouble, you can just email your video to becky@minnehaha.org and she'll upload it for you.

In order to have the time to put the video together, please upload your recordings by the end of November.

Food Ministries

MUMC has a number of food ministries, and we support two of them financially. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and Living Table

UCC. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or

Food Shelf on the memo line, or you can use our Give+ App and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf from the options. The Food Shelf also has their own website where you can sign up to get their newsletter as well as make a donation.

Minnehaha Snapshot: Third Quarter 2020

In the third quarter we held outdoor worship services that were also livestreamed on our YouTube channel. As colder weather approaches, we will return to online-only worship. Mandala Montessori preschool has returned to the building. So has the M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage school. Peace.

110 BACKPACKS
FOR CHILDREN



In August, Renee Beymer and friends gave 90 backpacks filled with school supplies to children of MinneHarvest clients. Twenty more went to Food Shelf clients.

8 LEARNED TAIKO
DRUMMING



In September, Eric Strom taught eight Minnehaha kids and their parents Taiko Drumming on the south lawn of the church.

25 FAMILIES AT SEPT.
FAMILY FUN EVENT



Twenty-five families kicked off the program year and picked up Sunday School supplies at our Family Fun Event. Sunday School will be online this school year.

100 PERCENT
PAID IN FULL



All bills, mortgage and apportionment payments, and staff salaries were paid through September 30. Thank you!

79.7 PERCENT OF BLDG.
LOAN PAID OFF



As of the end of September, we've paid off 79.7% of our 2010 building and remodeling project.

76 ATTENDED OUTDOOR
WORSHIP ON SEPT. 27



Seventy-six masked and distanced people attended the last of our eight outdoor worship services on Sept. 27. Another 70 people/families/groups watched on our YouTube channel.

8 YOUTH ON BICYCLING
ADVENTURE



In August, eight youth and three adults got together for a bicycling adventure in the city. Three other bike trips plus other activities (live and on Zoom) took place in the third quarter.

14,866 kWh



Our solar panels generated 14,866 kWh of electricity during the third quarter of 2020. That's enough to power 1-1/2 Minnesota houses for a year!

5 CONFIRMANDS
JOINED THE CHURCH



Sunday, Sept. 27 was Confirmation Sunday as five confirmands joined the church. Congratulations to: Cooper, Libby, Paige, Jaden, and Ava.

Note
from the
pastor



God In Our Midst

I don't know about you, but trying to plan for how to handle the upcoming holidays of Thanksgiving and Christmas is getting stressful. Our family gatherings are small by nature, but they are getting smaller by the moment. My brother forgot about the date of Thanksgiving, and his other travel plans mean he won't be able to gather with us because of his possible exposure to Covid-19. My father has decided that any gathering is too big for him right now. Our niece and her husband are forming a tight pod with another couple. Some of our friends work in healthcare, others work in warehouses, and yet others have health conditions that have prevented us from spending any time with them indoors. We, like many of you, might very well be spending the holidays this year either by ourselves or only with a couple of people. And, as we come upon the season where church attendance swells, I find myself cancelling event after event in my head.

Wednesday night dinners are on hold. The Harvest Dinner won't happen this year. The ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve service will be online, as will Christmas Eve. And while I am grateful for the online opportunities we do have, we all know it's not the same. To talk about community in this time feels odd, especially as we are unable to actually gather together to be community. To talk about God in our midst feels similarly ironic. What midst? We aren't gathered together for God to be in the middle of. But I am reminded, over and over, that God actually is in our midst. And, that we are community. Some members of our community were not able to gather with us even before the pandemic, but we didn't consider them any less a member of our community. And, we knew that God was with them, and with us, even if we couldn't get together for worship or other events. So, God is in our midst. In the midst of our thoughts, in the midst of our prayers, in the midst of our wishes for the opportunity to gather together again. God is in the midst of our tears and our joys and our longings. And, we are community. We are community online, we are community masked and standing 6 feet apart, we are community even when we remain in the safety of our homes. We are community in the ways we vote, in the ways we make calls and send cards and pray for one another. We are community even when being community is difficult. And, we are community even on the days some of us have a hard time getting out of bed.

Our holiday gatherings might be small or not at all. Our "normal" fall and winter church events might have to wait another year. But, we are still the community of Minnehaha United Methodist Church. And, God is still in our midst.

In Joy,

Becky



3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

Address Service Requested

Phone: 612/721-6231
Fax: 612/721-7289
E-Mail: becky@minnehaha.org
office@minnehaha.org
11/20



The background of the poster is a light blue wooden surface with several pumpkins and autumn leaves scattered around. The pumpkins are in shades of yellow, orange, and white. The leaves are in various shades of brown and orange.

JOIN US AT MINNEHAHA
UMC ON

*Thanksgiving Eve,
November 25th*

Stop by Minnehaha between 5:30 & 6:30pm
Drop-off Food Shelf Donations,
your Thanksgiving donation
Listen to live organ music, drink hot cider, pick up your
Advent bag, give thanks for community.
Masks required, we'll be outside & socially distanced

Join us online at 7pm
for our Ecumenical Neighborhood Thanksgiving Service
on the Minnehaha Youtube Channel

A small version of the Minnehaha logo, featuring a stylized 'M' with a cross-like shape inside, in a dark purple color.